

Word family: **jacket / jackets / jacketed / jacketing**

Base word: jacket

Plural: jackets

Verb forms: jacketed, jacketing

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “My favourite piece of clothing is a dark blue denim **jacket**...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **jacket** means a **short outer garment worn on the upper body, usually with sleeves and opening at the front**.

A **denim jacket** is a jacket made from denim fabric.

繁體中文：** **外套；夾克；通常穿在上半身、有袖、前方可打開的短外衣**

中文翻譯：

> “...a dark blue denim **jacket**...”

「.....一件深藍色的牛仔**外套 / 夾克**.....」

Here:

denim jacket = 牛仔外套 / 牛仔夾克

1. **jacket = short outer garment (衣服) — 外套；夾克**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A short or medium-length piece of outer clothing worn on the upper body, usually with sleeves and a front opening.

Practice 1 — Original

> “My favourite piece of clothing is a denim **jacket**.”

「我最喜歡的一件衣服是一件牛仔**外套**。」

Practice 2

> “He took off his **jacket** when he came inside.”

「他走進室內後脫下了**外套**。」

Practice 3

> “She wore a light **jacket** over her dress.”

「她在連身裙外穿了一件輕便**外套**。」

jacket = 穿在上半身外層的短外衣，通常有袖並在前面開合

Common:

- * denim jacket
- * leather jacket
- * suit jacket
- * sports jacket
- * bomber jacket
- * winter jacket

This is the main everyday sense.

2. **jacket** = a particular outer garment forming part of formal clothing (服裝款式) — 西裝外套；禮服上衣

Jacket can refer specifically to the upper part of a suit or other formal outfit.

Practice 4

> “He wore a dark suit **jacket**.”

「他穿了一件深色的**西裝外套**。」

Practice 5

> “Please wear a **jacket** and tie.”

「請穿**西裝外套**並打領帶。」

jacket = 西裝、禮服或正式服裝中的上衣部分

For strict semantic counting, this belongs under Meaning 1. It is a subtype, not a new underlying

concept.

3. **jacket = protective outer covering/casing (保護層) — 外殼 ; 護套 ; 包覆層**

This is the first genuinely different non-clothing sense.

****Meaning:**** An outer layer or covering placed around an object to protect, insulate, support, or contain it.

Practice 6

> “The cable has a protective plastic **jacket**.”

「這條電纜有一層塑膠保護**外皮 / 護套**。」

Practice 7

> “The pipe is surrounded by an insulating **jacket**.”

「管道外面包着一層隔熱**護套**。」

****jacket = 包在物體外圍、用來保護、隔熱、絕緣或支撐的外層****

Common specialist compounds include:

- * cable jacket
- * pipe jacket
- * insulation jacket
- * protective jacket

This metaphorically develops from a garment wrapped around a body.

4. **jacket = outer cover of a book (出版) — 書衣 ; 護封 ; 書套**

A ****book jacket****, especially a ****dust jacket****, is the removable paper cover around a hardback book.

Practice 8

> “The original ****jacket**** of the book is quite valuable.”

「這本書原來的****書衣 / 護封****相當有價值。」

Practice 9

> “The title appears on the front of the **jacket**.”

「書名印在**書衣**正面。」

book jacket = 包在精裝書外面的保護性 / 裝飾性封套

This is established enough to teach explicitly, even though conceptually it belongs to the protective-cover branch.

5. **jacket** = sleeve/cover around a record or similar item (包裝套) — 唱片套 ; 封套

In some publishing/media contexts, especially American English, **jacket** can mean the outer sleeve or cover surrounding a record or similar item.

Practice 10

> “The record still has its original **jacket**.”

「這張唱片仍保留原來的**唱片封套**。」

For strict counting, this belongs with Meaning 3/4:

> outer protective or decorative covering.

6. **jacket** = metal covering around a bullet (彈藥) — 彈頭金屬被甲 ; 包覆層

In ammunition terminology, a **jacket** is a metal layer around the core of a bullet.

Practice 11

> “The bullet has a copper **jacket**.”

「這顆子彈的彈頭有一層銅製**被甲 / 金屬包覆層**。」

The familiar term:

> **full metal jacket**

refers to a bullet whose core is largely enclosed in a harder metal outer layer.

This is a legitimate specialist sense, but it still belongs conceptually to the **outer protective casing** branch.

7. **jacket** = outer layer through which heating/cooling fluid flows (工程) — 夾套 ; 外套層

In engineering and laboratory equipment, a **jacket** can be a space or outer casing around a vessel, pipe, or engine through which fluid circulates for heating or cooling.

Practice 12

> “Cold water flows through the **jacket** around the vessel.”

「冷水會流經容器外圍的冷卻**夾套**。」

Practice 13

> “The engine uses a water **jacket** for cooling.”

「這部引擎利用水冷**夾套**散熱。」

jacket = 包圍設備的一層結構，用來讓液體流動以加熱或冷卻

This is an established engineering sense.

For core counting, it remains within the broader **outer casing/covering** concept.

8. **jacket** = natural skin of a potato (較少見) — 馬鈴薯皮

There is also a food-related use associated with potatoes.

In British English:

> **jacket potato**

means a potato baked in its skin.

Historically and in some contexts, **jacket** can refer to that outer skin or covering.

Practice 14

> “The potatoes were cooked in their **jackets**.”

「馬鈴薯連着**外皮**一起烹煮。」

This use is much less central today than the compound:

> jacket potato

So for the database, I would treat it as a **lower-priority lexical extension**, not an everyday core meaning.

9. **jacket** = supporting outer framework/structure (工程專門) — 外部支撐架；套架

In offshore engineering, a **jacket** can refer to the large steel lattice structure that supports an offshore platform.

Example:

> “The platform is supported by a steel **jacket**.”

「平台由鋼製**套架 / 支撐結構**支撐。」

This is a genuine modern specialist sense, but highly domain-specific.

Database status: recognize, lower priority.

10. **jacket** = verb: cover or enclose something in a protective layer (動詞) — 包覆；加護套

As a verb, **jacket** means to cover or surround something with a jacket or protective casing.

Practice 15

> “The pipe was **jacketed** with insulating material.”

「管道外面被隔熱材料**包覆**。」

Practice 16

> “The cable is **jacketed** in plastic.”

「電纜外面有塑膠**護套包覆**。」

jacket something = 在某物外圍加上一層保護、隔熱或其他功能性的外層

This is the main modern verb sense.

Related form: ****jacketed****

****Jacketed**** means covered or enclosed by an outer layer.

Practice 17

> “The laboratory uses a ****jacketed**** vessel.”

「實驗室使用一個帶****夾套的****容器。」

Practice 18

> “The wire is fully ****jacketed****.”

「電線完全被****外皮 / 護套包覆****。」

This is particularly common in technical contexts.

Related form: ****jacketing****

****Jacketing**** can mean the material or process used to provide an outer protective covering.

Practice 19

> “The cable requires weather-resistant ****jacketing****.”

「這條電纜需要耐候的****外護套材料****。」

****jacketing** = 外層包覆材料 / 包覆處理******

This is mainly technical.

Important distinction: ****jacket** vs **coat****

This is the most important clothing contrast.

****jacket****

usually:

- * shorter
- * ends around waist/hips
- * lighter or medium-weight

coat

usually:

- * longer
- * often warmer/heavier
- * primarily outerwear

- > denim jacket
- > winter coat

There is overlap, but they are not identical.

Important distinction: **jacket vs blazer**

blazer

is a particular structured jacket, usually smarter/formal in appearance.

jacket

is the broad category.

- > denim jacket
- > leather jacket
- > blazer

A blazer is a type of jacket.

Important distinction: **jacket vs cardigan**

jacket

is outerwear and usually made of woven, leather, denim, technical material, etc.

cardigan

is knitted and sweater-like.

A cardigan is not normally called a jacket.

Important distinction: **jacket vs shirt**

shirt

is normally worn as a main/top layer close to the body.

jacket

is normally an outer layer worn over a shirt, T-shirt, dress, etc.

This distinction appears directly in your passage:

> throw the jacket on over a T-shirt or shirt.

Important distinction: **jacket vs cover**

cover

is the broad general word for something that covers/protects another thing.

jacket

suggests a fitted outer layer surrounding an object.

> book cover

> dust jacket

> cable jacket

So **jacket** often carries the image of something wrapping around another thing.

Important distinction: **jacket vs casing**

casing

means a hard or structural outer shell.

jacket

can be softer, removable, insulating, protective, or layered.

> engine casing

> cable jacket

The two overlap in technical contexts.

Countability note

Jacket is normally countable.

Clothing

> a jacket

> two jackets

Protective covering

> a cable jacket

> several protective jackets

Book publishing

> the original jacket

> replacement jackets

Useful compounds

Many common compounds do **not** require new core meanings:

* denim jacket

* leather jacket

* suit jacket

* sports jacket

* bomber jacket

* dinner jacket

* life jacket

* book jacket

- * dust jacket
- * cable jacket
- * water jacket

life jacket

A **life jacket** is a buoyancy garment designed to keep a person afloat in water.

Although highly lexicalized, it remains conceptually a type of **protective wearable jacket**, so I would store it as a compound rather than create another base meaning.

Useful expression: **dust jacket — 書衣 ; 護封**

A removable printed paper cover around a hardback book.

Practice 20

> “The first edition still has its original dust **jacket**.”

「這本初版書仍保留原裝**書衣 / 護封**。」

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **jacket**
- * **jackets**
- * **jacketed**
- * **jacketing**

The word's semantic network is highly coherent.

There are essentially two major underlying images:

1. **a garment worn around the upper body**
2. **an outer layer wrapped around something**

From the second develop:

- * book jacket
- * cable jacket
- * pipe jacket

- * bullet jacket
- * cooling/heating jacket
- * technical jacketing

The SOP tells us to sweep domains broadly first and then merge contexts that still share one underlying semantic idea rather than artificially count each industry as a different meaning.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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jacket — clothing	穿在上半身外層、通常有袖並可在前方開合的短外套 / 夾克
jacket — suit/formal clothing	西裝或正式服裝的上衣部分；屬於 clothing 義
jacket — protective covering	包在物件外面的保護、絕緣、隔熱或支撐層
book jacket	精裝書外面的裝飾 / 保護性書衣或護封
record jacket	唱片等外面的封套；屬於 covering 義
bullet jacket	包在彈頭核心外面的金屬被甲
engineering jacket	包圍設備供加熱 / 冷卻流體通過的夾套
jacket potato / in its jacket	連皮焗薯；jacket 指外皮的用法較低頻
offshore jacket	海上平台的鋼製外部支撐套架；專門
jacket — verb	用保護、隔熱或其他功能性的外層把某物包覆起來
jacketed	被外層 / 護套包覆的
jacketing	外護套材料或包覆處理

For your original sentence

> “My favourite piece of clothing is a dark blue denim ****jacket****...”

The exact meaning is:

****jacket = 穿在上半身外面的短外套****

So:

> ****dark blue denim jacket****

= ****深藍色牛仔外套 / 牛仔夾克****

For your database, I would count ****2 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****jacket****:

1. ****a short outer garment worn on the upper body****
2. ****an outer protective/functional covering or casing around something****

I would put ****book jacket, cable jacket, bullet jacket, water jacket, record jacket****, etc. under #2 rather than split them by industry. The verb ****jacket = cover with an outer layer**** aligns with #2.

Potato and offshore-engineering uses are genuine but lower-priority specialist extensions rather than additional everyday core meanings.